

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

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OUTLOOK 2007



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

Mail clients have become rendered much less useful with all the new online mail services, and Microsoft's Outlook seems like the only one being updated at every MS Office release. It's much more than just a mail client, as you probably know. In the past, we've given you some tips on the other applications in Office 2007. Let's now take a look at mail-related as well as some not-so-obvious features of Outlook 2007.



Automatic Formatting For Calendar

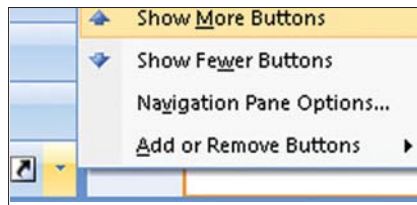
The Calendar in Outlook allows you to set colours to tasks according to keywords you enter, which can make grouping and

marking of tasks easy. This feature is called Auto Format. We need to use the Day/Week/Month view to see this feature in action. Select View > Current View > Day/Week/Month or Day/Week/Month with AutoPreview. Then right-click on any empty field and click Automatic Formatting. Click Add to add rules, and enter a name for the rule. Click on the Condition button, and enter any keywords that you want to find in the tasks. Click OK and choose a colour for that keyword. Press OK again, and the tasks with the keywords you've chosen will get highlighted with the colour.



Showing All The Navigation Pane Buttons

The navigation pane at the left is the easiest way to access the various components of Outlook 2007. By default, the number of items is limited to only the two or three prominent features. To show all the features buttons, click on the drop-down icon in the Navigation Pane at the left. Click on Show more buttons, and an item will



Enable all of Outlook's features in the navigation pane

appear on the Navigation Pane. Follow the steps over and over till all the items you need are added.



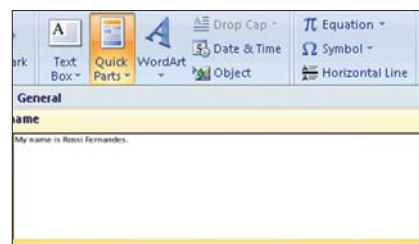
Additional Views And Features

Some of the more advanced views don't have icons on the toolbars: part of Microsoft's goal is to simplify the interface of their applications. For example, to choose the different views of the features—Calendar, Notes, Tasks, etc.—you need to select View > Current View and choose the view of your choice. The easier way to access these views is to enable the Advanced toolbar. Right-click anywhere on the toolbar and click Advanced. With the Advanced toolbar in place, you can easily access the other views using the drop-down menu.



Avoid Repeating Text

You probably have our own little ways of saying Hello or Goodbye, or maybe a casual signature, which you follow when you compose mails. Knowing that you use that same set of sentences over and over again, Outlook 2007 has a feature called Quick Parts, which lets you save such sentences so you can use them later. While writing a mail, highlight the text you want to save. Click the Insert tab on the Ribbon. Click on Quick Parts and click "Save selection to Quick Parts gallery". To access any of the selections you saved, click on the Quick Parts button again and choose a selection.



Quick Parts lets you add commonly used sentences to mails



Setting Up Multiple Signatures

Sometimes you require to use different signatures for different purposes. Outlook allows you to create and switch between signatures with a couple of clicks. Click on the Insert tab on the Ribbon, and click on the Signature button. Here, click on the signature of your choice. If you have no signatures created, click on Signatures... Click the New button to create a new one. Give a name to the signature and then enter the signature details, and use the formatting tools made available. Once done, click Save, and click New again to create more signatures. Click OK to save them and return to the mail composing window.



Translating Selections

Microsoft Office has resources like encyclopaedias that let you quickly